



The Bose Lifestyle 38 and Lifestyle 48 Home Entertainment suite

out, "While ordinary mobile phones have only 80 to 100 parts, Vertu's internal structure features more than 400 mechanical parts."

Yet another lifestyle product to hit the Indian

market is the Bose Lifestyle 38 and Lifestyle 48 Home Entertainment suite (approx. Rs 2 lakh), which features the uMusic Intelligent playback system. uMusic organizes and stores

200-340 hours of music in the system, and can "learn" a user's individual listening preferences and play songs from the database accordingly.

Says Ratish Pandey, General Manager, Bose Corporation India, "People associated us with high-end speakers till 1990. Today we are offering an integrated home theatre system that fits into the lifestyle segment, with an intuitive playback system to enhance user experience."

Meera Vankipuram

IT TRENDS

Customised HRD Solutions

"We don't believe in training people *en masse*," asserts Sheila Vasan Singla, founder of Chrysalis HRD, a customised training solutions company based in Gurgaon. Specialising in "Human Performance Improvement" (HPI), Chrysalis has trained over 20,000 people across 50 organisations in India.

What sets this HRD organisation apart is their customised training programmes, specific to the IT industry's requirements. With major clients such as Hutch, Airtel, Reliance and most major BPOs who use e-mail and chat services to communicate with customers, Chrysalis has developed unique solutions

customised for the industry.

Stress management for customer relation executives, effective handling of irate customers, increasing efficiency of call-centre employee (increasing number of calls per hour), efficient methods for team leaders to manage multi-cultural teams, and women's empowerment modules are some of Chrysalis's offerings.

The company has developed a unique set of business drivers and distinct areas for performance improvement, and customizes HPI solutions on the basis of these parameters.

With a 21-member team (including clinical psychologists, psychometricians, marketing executives and trainers) based in Gurgaon and Mumbai, Sheila believes in keeping the Chrysalis family "small and effective."

Meera Vankipuram

MOBILE DIGITAL SECRETARIES

A Smarter Smartphone

Under trial in the US are smartphones that learn the user's daily habits so they can become "mobile digital secretaries." The technology is the brainchild of Nathan Eagle and Sandy Pentland of MIT. The system is based on mobile messaging software called Context, written by developers at the University of Helsinki and the Helsinki Institute of Technology. The software builds a profile of a user's routine by asking them what they're up to when they come into range of a new mobile mast.

Such a "smarter smartphone" would learn about people's preferences by logging calls and noting when applications, such as the camera, are used. Location-based functions would allow the phone to keep a record of where one works and socialises. The phone could also make note

GENDER



BENDERS

Glenn Sequeira vs Kim Nagotkar Disable All Alerts In MSN Messenger



2 min
09 sec

"How long will it take?" was his hesitant question as he sat down at the terminal. On being told the task, he brought up MSN Messenger and began searching its menus. Perhaps it's in the Action menu, Umm no luck here. Tools? Yes, it does have Options... In the options dialog now, where are the alerts? There in the General tab. Finally, task accomplished.



3 min
36 sec

Nervous but quite sure of finding her way about, Kim looked pensively at the monitor. Where is MSN Messenger here? A minute later, she was perusing its menus. Was it in the File menu, or was it the Help menu? Ah yes, of course the Tools menu. a few quick mouse-clicks later, she was at the General tab and had disabled the alerts. Whew! Done at last.



Sheila Vasan Singla, founder, Chrysalis HRD

Photograph: Meera Vankipuram